

Choosing by use, and buying tips for India

General guidance for shoppers in India. Not specific to any one product; always check the exact configuration and current price before buying.

Students

Prioritise weight, battery life, a comfortable keyboard and a fair price. A 14 or 15.6 inch laptop with 8 to 16 GB RAM and a 512 GB SSD covers most courses. Engineering and design students who use heavy software should consider 16 GB RAM and a stronger processor, and possibly a dedicated GPU.

Programming and data work

Choose 16 GB RAM as the target, a fast SSD and a recent i5 or Ryzen 5 class processor or better. A good keyboard and a clear screen matter because you use them for hours. A dedicated GPU is only needed for machine learning experiments, and even then cloud notebooks are an option. Linux, Windows with WSL and macOS are all workable; pick the one that matches the tools you use.

Business and office use

Look for a sturdy build, a good keyboard, good battery life, security features and Windows Pro if your workplace needs it. Business laptops usually favour reliability and service over raw speed, and they often come with better warranty options.

Creators (video, photo, design)

A colour-accurate display, 16 GB RAM or more, a strong processor and often a dedicated GPU matter most. OLED or high-coverage IPS panels help with colour work. Plenty of fast storage helps because project files are large.

Windows, macOS or Linux

Windows has the widest software and hardware choice and is the usual pick for gaming. macOS is popular for creative work, development and long battery life, with a higher entry price and fixed RAM and storage. Linux runs well on many laptops and is favoured by some developers; check hardware compatibility first.

Buying tips for India

The same model name is often sold with different processors, RAM and storage, so match the exact configuration code before paying. Compare the final price including offers across a few sellers and watch for sale periods. Buy from authorised sellers and keep the GST invoice for warranty claims. Check that the brand has a service centre in your city, because repair convenience matters. Look at what the warranty covers (accidental damage and battery are often extra). Be careful with unusually cheap listings, refurbished units sold as new, and old-generation stock sold at a new-generation price.